NATIONAL GOVERNMENT CONSTITUENCIES DEVELOPMENT FUND

Maendeleo kwa Wote · Field Activity Planning and Monitoring

FAPM: Your First Activity, Start to Finish

Practice guide for new users, October 2026

This guide takes you through one practice activity from the first click to the last. You will record a field visit, build its team, send it to the CEO, approve it, follow it while it happens and close it. It takes about 45 minutes. Do every step in order and you will have used every main part of the system.

> **Use the test system for this practice, never the live one.** Nothing in FAPM can be deleted once it is approved, so a practice activity on the live system would stay there for good. Your trainer will give you the test system's web address.

What FAPM is

FAPM (Field Activity Planning and Monitoring) is the Office of the CEO's confidential record of field activities: who is going where, when, at what cost, and whether the CEO approved it. It is marked RESTRICTED. Only four people have an account, and you should never show its screens or printouts to anyone else.

Role	What they do in this practice
Chief of Staff	Records the activity, adds the team and costs, sends it to the CEO, confirms it started, records the report and closes it.
Chief Executive Officer	Approves the activity and looks at the dashboard.
Assistant Chief of Staff	Records who actually travelled and the actual costs.
System Administrator	Has already loaded the staff list and settings before the practice. Has nothing to do here.

If one person is practising alone, sign in as each role in turn when the step says so. Sign out first each time (your name, top right, then Sign out).

Before you begin

Your sign-in details: the email and password your trainer gave you for each role you will play.

A small PDF saved on your computer, any letter will do. You will attach it twice, once as the memo and once as the report.

Your phone, only if the system asks for a six-digit code when you sign in. Your trainer will help you set this up.

The practice details below. Keep this page open beside the screen and type exactly what it says.

The practice activity

Field on the screen	What to type or choose
Title	Monitoring visit, Nakuru Town East
Category	Monitoring & Evaluation
Activity type	Monitoring visit
Objective	Check progress of ongoing NG-CDF projects in Nakuru Town East
Expected outputs	A site report on each project visited
Planned start	Today's date
Number of days	2
County, then Constituency	Nakuru, then Nakuru Town East
Venue	NG-CDF Nakuru Town East office
Requesting department	Monitoring & Evaluation
Memo number	NGCDF/ME/01/2026
Date received	Today's date
Team	Peter Otieno (Team lead), Amina Hassan (Member), Joseph Mutua (Driver)

Fuel for the Board vehicle	8,000.00

Words you will see

Word	Meaning
Activity	One field trip or event, with its whole team.
Draft	Saved but not yet sent to the CEO. You can still change anything.
Awaiting decision	Sent to the CEO, who has not yet decided.
Approved, Returned, Declined	The CEO's answer. Returned means "fix this and send it back". Declined is final.
In progress	The team is in the field.
DSA	Daily Subsistence Allowance. The system works it out from each officer's job grade and the destination.
Back-to-office report	The report the department sends after the trip.
Closed	Finished. Nothing more can be changed.

Part 1: Sign in

Every role, the first time

1. **Open the web address** your trainer gave you. You will see the NG-CDF sign-in page.
2. **Type your email and password,** then press **Sign in**.
3. **The first time only,** the NG-CDF Board Data Privacy Statement appears. Read it, tick the box to agree, and accept. You cannot go further without agreeing.
4. **If asked for a code,** open the authenticator app on your phone and type the six digits it shows.
5. **You are in.** The menu down the left side takes you everywhere. The word RESTRICTED at the top reminds you the screens are confidential.

> **Good to know.** If you leave the system untouched for 15 minutes it signs you out, so save your work as you go. Five wrong passwords in a row lock the account for 30 minutes; the Chief of Staff can unlock it sooner from User accounts.

Part 2: Record the activity

Sign in as the Chief of Staff

1. **Click Activity register** in the left menu, then the green **Record activity** button at the top right.
2. **Fill in the form** from the practice table: title, category, activity type, objective and expected outputs.
3. **Under Dates,** choose today as the Planned start and type 2 in Number of days. The green box beside it fills in the end date (tomorrow) and "1 night" by itself.
4. **Under First location,** choose the county Nakuru, then the constituency Nakuru Town East, and type the venue.
5. **Under Source,** choose the requesting department, type the memo number and the date received, then click **Choose file** beside Source document and pick your PDF.
6. **Press Save as draft.** The activity's own page opens. At the top you will see its reference number (it starts with FAPM), the status **Draft** and a **Late notice** label.

> **Why "Late notice"?** The activity was recorded less than 7 working days before it starts, so the system tells the CEO. That is expected in this practice.

Made a mistake? Press **Edit** at the top of the activity page, correct it and press **Save changes**. You can also use the small pencil at the end of the activity's row in the Activity register. If you leave a required box empty, a red message tells you which one and nothing you typed is lost.

Part 3: Add the team

Still the Chief of Staff

1. **Click the Team tab** on the activity page, then **Add officers**. A window lists the staff, grouped by department.

2. **Type Otieno in the search box.** Tick Peter Otieno. Under each name you can see how many field days that officer already has this year, which helps you share field work fairly.
3. **Choose Add as Team lead** in the role box, then press **Add 1 to team**.
4. **Do the same for Amina Hassan** as Member and **Joseph Mutua** as Driver.
5. **Check the Team tab.** All three are listed with their department, role and field days.

> **A name in red?** It means that officer is already on another approved activity on these dates. The system asks for a reason before it lets you add them. For this practice, choose someone else.

Part 4: Check the costs

Still the Chief of Staff

1. **Click the Costs tab.** The system has already worked out DSA for each officer for 1 night. You do not type DSA.
2. **Press Add cost,** choose Board vehicle fuel as the cost type, type 8,000.00 as the amount and save.
3. **Look at the total** at the top of the page. It is the DSA plus the fuel, in Kenya Shillings.

Part 5: Send it to the CEO

Still the Chief of Staff

1. **Press Submit to CEO** at the top of the activity page.
2. **The status changes to Awaiting decision.** The CEO now sees it in their Decision queue and gets an alert.
3. **Sign out.**

> **If Submit is refused,** a message says what is missing: at least one officer, one location and the memo. Add it and press Submit to CEO again.

Part 6: The CEO approves

Sign in as the CEO

1. **Look at the bell** at the top right. It shows a new alert for the activity.
2. **Click Decision queue** in the left menu. The activity is listed with its dates, team, cost and any warnings, all on one screen.
3. **Press Approve,** add a comment if you like, and confirm.
4. **The status becomes Approved.** The Chief of Staff and the Assistant get an alert.
5. **Sign out.**

The CEO can also press Return (with a note saying what to fix) or Decline (final). Both need a comment.

Part 7: The team sets off

Sign in as the Chief of Staff

1. **Open the activity** from the Activity register: click its title.
2. **Press Confirm commencement.** This tells the system the team really left. The status becomes **In progress**.
3. **Click In the field today** in the left menu. Peter, Amina and Joseph are listed with Nakuru Town East and the day they return.
4. **Sign out.**

> **Why this matters.** If an approved activity is not confirmed by the end of its first day it turns amber, and red after two days, so the CEO can follow up.

Part 8: Record who travelled

Sign in as the Assistant Chief of Staff

1. **Open the activity** and click the **Team** tab.
2. **Set the attendance** box beside each name to **Attended**. For practice, set Joseph Mutua to **Did not attend**.

3. **Look at the Costs tab.** Only people who attended count towards actual days and cost.

Part 9: The activity ends and the report comes in

Sign in as the Chief of Staff

1. **Press Mark completed** and confirm. Leave the date empty to use the planned end date. The status becomes **Completed**, and the system sets the date the report is due (5 working days later).
2. **Press Record report.** Enter today as the date received, type what was achieved, any findings and recommendations, attach your PDF as the report file and save.
3. **The status becomes Report received.** The Report tab shows what was achieved beside what was expected.

Part 10: Record actual costs and close

Assistant Chief of Staff, then Chief of Staff

1. **As the Assistant, open the Costs tab.** In the Actual amount box on each line, type what was really spent. Type 0 for Joseph's DSA, since he did not travel. Click outside the box and it saves by itself.
2. **Type a Finance reference** on each line if you have one.
3. **Check the difference** between planned and actual shown on each line and in the total.
4. **Sign in as the Chief of Staff and press Close.** The status becomes **Closed**. The activity is now a permanent record and nothing on it can be changed.

> **If Close is refused,** the message says what is missing: the report, attendance for someone, or an actual amount on a cost line. Fill it in and press Close again.

Part 11: Look around

Sign in as the CEO

Menu item	What you will see
Dashboard	Counts of activities in each stage, late-notice activities, overdue reports and cost. Click any number to see the activities behind it.
Activity register	Every activity. Use the search box and filters; the count shows how many match.
Calendar	Activities by month or week, coloured by status.
Staff participation	Each officer's field days and costs. Search for Peter Otieno.
Department costs	DSA, travel and totals per department, against budget.
Reports	Ten standard reports. Open one and press PDF or Print. Every copy carries RESTRICTED, your name and the time.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
A red message under a box	That box is required or the value is not allowed. Correct it and save again.
A red message at the top right	The system refused the step and says why, for example a missing memo. Do what it says.
Back on the sign-in page	You were signed out after 15 minutes without activity, or because someone signed in with your account elsewhere. Sign in again.
"This account is locked"	Wait 30 minutes, or ask the Chief of Staff to unlock it.
A button you expected is missing	Your role does not do that step, or the activity is in a different stage. Check which role the step names.
Something else	Write down the activity's reference number, what you pressed and the exact message, and tell your trainer. Do not send screenshots outside the team.

You have finished when

The practice activity shows **Closed** in the Activity register.

You have signed in as each role you will use for real.

You can find the Decision queue, In the field today and Reports without help.

When you are comfortable, your trainer will give you your account on the live system. From then on, record real activities from the memos and work plans the Office of the CEO receives, the same way you did here.